ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 1/12: Chronology, 1707-1761

```
1707-12 Bahadur Shah -> 1712-13 Jahandar/Zulfiqar
1713-19 Farrukhsiyar/Sayyids -> 1719 brief emperors
1719-48 Muhammad Shah | 1720 Sayyid fall | 1739 Nadir Shah
1748-54 Ahmad Shah -> 1754-59 Alamgir II -> 1759-60 Shah Jahan III -> Shah Alam II from 1760
1748-67 Abdali invasions | 1761 Third Panipat
BOUND -> Buxar 1764/Diwani 1765 and Company state belong Modern History.
MUST REMEMBER: Mughal decline was multi-causal: jagirdari stress, succession, war, regional
  power and fiscal-military change interacted.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 2/12: Decline as a converging system

```
NOT -> one weak ruler + one religion + one battle + immediate collapse
STRUCTURE -> succession + noble faction + jagir/agrarian stress + war
REGION -> successor states and resistance powers reorganise authority
SHOCK -> Nadir/Abdali exploit and deepen pre-existing weakness
CONTINUITY -> dynasty, trade, agriculture and culture persist unevenly
VERDICT -> central contraction plus regional reordering.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 3/12: Succession and the Sayyid wizarat

```
NO PRIMOGENITURE -> prince needs province + army + noble/Rajput coalition
EMPEROR -> seal/title/appointment legitimacy persists after coercive decline
WAZIR/NOBLES -> compete for access, jagirs, governorships and succession
SAYYIDS -> Abdullah + Husain Ali make/unmake emperors; Farrukhsiyar 1719
1720 FALL -> does not restore uncontested monarchy
TRAP -> Irani/Turani/Hindustani labels are networks, not permanent parties.
```

```
ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 4/12: Four jagirdari terms
JAGIR -> transferable revenue assignment | MANSAB -> rank/service claim
PAIBAQI -> revenue pool awaiting/available for assignment
BE-JAGIRI -> delay or shortage of suitable productive assignment
JAMA -> paper assessment | HASIL -> realised collection
TRANSFER -> restrains entrenchment but encourages short-term extraction
RULE -> crisis means malfunction and scarcity, not disappearance of jagirs.
```

```
ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 5/12: The jagirdari feedback loop
MORE CLAIMS -> mansabdars + Deccani/Maratha entrants + court rewards
POOR JAGIR -> low hasil + debt + thin contingent
EXTRACT -> short tenure encourages coercion/corruption
LOCAL RESPONSE -> zamindar bargain/resistance + peasant flight + chauth
RESULT -> still lower hasil -> faction for better office/assignment
VERDICT -> fiscal + administrative + military + social feedback.
```

```
ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 6/12: The inherited Deccan burden
1687-1707 -> annexation + forts + garrisons + long supply + emperor absent north
CLAIMANTS -> defeated Deccani/Maratha elites enter Mughal service system
MARATHA WAR -> parallel revenue and mobile resistance reduce collection
AURANGZEB CHOICE -> buffers removed and settlements missed
INHERIT -> earlier mansab growth + agrarian/local power + no primogeniture
TRAP -> responsibility matters, but one ruler did not create every structure.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 7/12: From centre to region: a spectrum

```
CENTRE -> emperor retains legitimacy and titles
AUTONOMOUS PROVINCE -> Mughal governor controls revenue/army, nominal loyalty
SUCCESSOR STATE -> durable court and provincial fiscal-military regime
RESISTANCE STATE -> zamindar/community/military base builds new authority
TRIBUTE/CHAUTH -> influence without uniform direct administration
RULE -> devolution and adaptation, not simple secession or anarchy.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 8/12: Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad compared

```
BENGAL -> Murshid Quli Khan; revenue control + commerce + nominal tribute
AWADH -> Saadat Khan; zamindar management + Ganga military-fiscal base
HYDERABAD -> Nizam-ul-Mulk; Deccan base after withdrawal from Delhi faction
COMMON -> Mughal titles/offices/administration and Persianate court
DIFFER -> ecology, revenue, military network and company exposure
TRAP -> autonomy did not begin with modern independence declarations.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 9/12: Jats, Sikhs and Marathas: bounded snapshot

```
JATS -> Churaman/Badan Singh/Suraj Mal; Bharatpur forts + zamindari/routes
SIKHS -> Banda phase -> repression/reorganisation -> misls/Dal Khalsa
ROHILLAS -> Afghan service/migration networks establish Rohilkhand power
MARATHAS -> Shahu + Peshwa + Holkar/Scindia/Gaekwad/Bhonsle
INSTRUMENT -> chauth/sardeshmukhi + mobile armies + bargaining
TRAP -> no single anti-Mughal bloc or uniform successor empire.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 10/12: Nadir Shah, Abdali and Panipat

```
1739 KARNAL -> Mughal command/faction failure -> Delhi sack and extraction
NADIR -> devastating raid and exposure; not original cause or Indian annexation
ABDALI 1748-67 -> repeated Punjab/north-India interventions
1761 -> Abdali coalition defeats Marathas; Mughal emperor not main belligerent
CAUSE -> supply + alliances + non-combatants + Rohilla/Abdali coordination
LIMIT -> Panipat checks northern bid, not Maratha power or British inevitability.
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Hyderabad, Awadh and Bengal were successor states that adapted Mughal
  institutions, not mere evidence of anarchy.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 11/12: Regional economic and cultural continuity

```
CONTINUE -> agriculture + textiles + internal trade + credit + urban demand
DISRUPT -> war + multiple levies + route insecurity + invasion by region
BENGAL -> commercial strength can coexist with weak Delhi centre
PATRONAGE -> Awadh/Hyderabad/Rajasthan/Punjab/Bengal/Maratha courts
ARTISTS/LITERATI -> movement creates regional styles using Mughal forms
VERDICT -> political fragmentation is not civilisational darkness.
EVIDENCE LIMIT: The eighteenth century is a transition with regional growth and new
  competition, not a teleological prelude to British rule.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 12/12: Non-inevitability and final answer spine

```
PERIODISE -> 1687-1707 burden -> 1707-39 court/region -> 1739-61 multipolarity
EXPLAIN -> jagir feedback + succession/wizarat + local/regional power
SHOCK -> Nadir/Abdali reveal and deepen weakness
QUALIFY -> economy/culture and Mughal legitimacy continue unevenly
HISTORIOGRAPHY -> Sarkar + Chandra + agrarian + regional synthesis
PYQ -> zero direct Topic-25 routes, 2018-2026; Mains has no key
BRIDGE -> fragmentation permits Company gains; Modern History explains them.
```